



Security Watch

Macromedia Flash Player Vulnerability

The Problem

A vulnerability has been reported in Macromedia Flash Player, and has been described as "highly critical." Many users have Flash Player 6 or 7 currently installed, and the vulnerability has been reported in Flash Player version 7.0.19.0 and prior on Windows.

Damages

The bug could be exploited by using specially crafted (malformed) SWF files to execute arbitrary code on the machines of users induced into visiting sites under the control of hackers.

Solution

To find out what version you have installed (if you have different browsers installed, you'll have to check each browser independently), use your browser to access www.macromedia.com/software/flash/about. If it's below version 7.0.19.0, you'll need to update to Flash Player 8 (8.0.22.0) or apply the Flash Player 7 update (7.0.61.0 or 7.0.60.0). The Flash Player 8 download is at www.macromedia.com/shockwave/download/download.cgi?P1_Prod_Version=ShockwaveFlash.

The Flash Player 7 update is at <http://www.macromedia.com/go/d9c2fe33>. Note that the only reason you'd want to apply the Flash Player 7 update is that Flash Player 8 is not supported by Windows 95, Windows NT, or classic Macintosh operating systems.

right to chunks of code rather than a complete program.

With this new twist to the tale, it looks like Sony has a number of new battles to contend with, and their copyright protection codes will be off the CDs for a while. So, it's a field day for music pirates?

COPYRIGHT ISSUES AGAIN

Google Print Faces Roadblocks

The Authors Guild, an association of published authors, and five major publishers—including Penguin and McGraw-Hill—are suing to prevent Google from scanning copyrighted material in libraries without explicit permission. But Google seems keen on thumbing their face—they have launched Google Print, a service that provides users with entire texts of books and government documents, scanned and indexed from five major libraries in the US.

These books, according to Google, are in the public domain, which means their copyrights have expired and that anybody can access them and use them for copying and publishing. But Google also plans to scan and index many other books that aren't yet in the public domain. The groups suing Google are accusing it of not having obtained

explicit permission from the books' authors.

Google began the library-scanning project late last year. The company had postponed the scanning of copyrighted books in August to give writers and publishers more time to opt out of the program; the scanning of copyrighted material resumed early last month with a larger emphasis on books that were no longer in print.

Google claims that since only excerpts of the books will be made available to anyone who searches them, they are not violating any copyright laws. However, the copyright cases being filed by publishers may still prove to be an obstacle in the company's gargantuan copying and indexing project.

For us, of course, the project is good news—do visit <http://print.google.com> and tell us what you think!

AI AND FACE RECOGNITION

Automatic Photo Tagging!

There are a number of photo sharing and image management software to suit your specific requirements. Flickr and Picasa are the most preferred, and the rest of the field is struggling to keep up with them.

Amidst this crowd of

HOT

DVD-Writers

These can burn DVDs and CDs and also play back almost all formats. Most come for about Rs 3,000, including high-quality ones. We think DVD-Writers should be part of standard equipment on any computer!

Combo Drives

Combo drives were huge sell-outs when they hit the market.

However, we think it's time to say goodbye to them! Who needs a Combo drive when you can get a DVD-Writer for just a few hundred rupees more?



photo sharing services, a new service from Redwood City, California, which automates the tagging of pictures using artificial intelligence and face recognition technology, is hoping to stand out and grab some market share.

The service, called Riya, has developed software that can recognise who is in a picture, and tag it with their names. Photos can be uploaded to Riya from hard drives, photo-storage sites such as Yahoo! Photos, and from e-mail attachments in Gmail, Hotmail and Yahoo! Mail. The service will soon be including uploads from Flickr, Outlook, Friendster and MySpace.

The results of this new service have been said to be very impressive: testers have said that the software was even able to differentiate



One Silly Question

"What would you rename 'Windows' to?"



"The 'Sea', since it's unfathomable"

Mudasser Mulla, Mumbai



"I don't know. 'Furniture' maybe?"

Pooja Chipalia, Mumbai



"I would call it 'Mint-Windows!'"

Bhavik Doshi, Gujarat



"I feel 'Peep-out' is fine."

Nirja Gandhi, Mumbai



"What else but 'Doors'?"

Heer Sanghvi, Mumbai